

# Kate Bugakova / Techbar SW — Call Prep

June 8, 2026 | 10:30 AM CDT | 30 min | Teams

Organized by: David O'Hara

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## Background / History

Kate Bugakova is the Business Development lead at Techbar SW — she owns the front-door function, sourcing and managing partnerships for the firm. She initiated this outreach, which puts her in active exploration mode rather than responding to an inbound.

Her career is grounded in enterprise BD and strategic partnerships at Eastern European software firms. She spent a significant tenure at CHI Software — a large Ukrainian dev shop — where she rose to Head/Director of Strategic Partnerships. At CHI she represented the company at industry events (AI World Congress London, South Summit) and managed complex international partnership negotiations. She writes publicly on LinkedIn about BD practice and IT staffing trends.

Her move to Techbar SW appears to be a step into a smaller, likely newer venture with a similar talent model to CHI but different positioning. She is not a technologist — she is a connector and commercial operator.

*CRM / prior engagement: Scheduled via Alice Mburu (May 13, 2026). No prior deal history, proposals, or existing IES relationship. This is a true first conversation.*

## Company Overview

Techbar SW is a boutique software engineering and talent firm with Eastern European engineering roots (Ukraine-origin, given Kate's CHI background). Under 100 employees. Madrid-area commercial presence, distributed engineering base.

### Three service lines:

Staff Augmentation — senior engineers embedded in client's team, tools, and sprint cadence. First candidates in 48-72 hours; onboarding in 1-2 weeks. European timezone delivery.

Dedicated Engineering Teams — stable cross-functional teams built around a specific initiative. Techbar manages hiring, performance, and team composition as scope evolves.

Capability / Engineering Centers — permanent units aligned to long-term product roadmap. Deep domain expertise as a durable client extension.

**Technical focus:** AI/ML integration, cloud migration (AWS, Azure, GCP), legacy modernization, data infrastructure, compliance-heavy systems.

**Market position:** Competes with N-iX, Ciklum, CHI Software. Differentiator appears to be speed of deployment and dedicated team stability. Expanding Western European and North American commercial footprint — which likely explains the US outreach.

## Improving's Position

Improving is a technology consulting firm — not a staff augmentation provider. We sell Improving consultants on Improving engagements. We don't white-label external talent or resell third-party engineers. Establish this early so neither party wastes time on a misaligned pitch.

## Realistic partnership shapes:

Referral exchange — the most natural play. Techbar encounters a client needing advisory or consulting (Improving's lane); Improving encounters a client needing rapid engineering scale (Techbar's lane). Works if both firms are honest about where their models end.

Co-sell into enterprise accounts — lower probability. If Techbar has an enterprise relationship needing deeper consulting capability alongside their dev team, Improving could add value there.

Sub-contractor / bench access — lowest probability given Improving's model. Don't lead with it.

*No prior Improving-Techbar deal history. David enters as a clean slate — fully direct about fit from the start.*

## Proposed Agenda

| Time      | Topic                                                                                                                    |
|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 0:00-0:05 | Introductions — let Kate set context. "What were you hoping to get out of this call?" Don't pitch first.                 |
| 0:05-0:15 | Understand Techbar's client profile: industries, company sizes, geographies, typical engagement shape                    |
| 0:15-0:22 | David frames Improving's model clearly — what we do, what we don't, what partnership realistically looks like            |
| 0:22-0:27 | If a fit angle emerges, get specific: is there a client or deal in mind, or is this a longer-horizon relationship build? |
| 0:27-0:30 | Define a concrete next step or close cleanly                                                                             |

## Talking Points

### 1. Let her show her hand first.

Open with: "Kate, what were you hoping to explore on this call?" Kate initiated this outreach — she has a thesis. Surface it before framing anything from Improving's side. Her answer tells you whether this is a referral pitch, a co-sell play, or a bench inquiry.

### 2. Understand who their clients actually are.

Ask about industries, company sizes, and geographies. This determines whether there's any realistic client overlap. Mid-market or enterprise accounts in the US or Western Europe — the conversation gets interesting. 20-person startups in Spain — the referral loop probably doesn't close.

### 3. Be direct about the Improving model early.

"We staff Improving consultants into client engagements — that's the model. We don't white-label or resell external talent. So the most natural partnership, if there is one, is probably a referral exchange or a co-sell scenario where both firms bring distinct value to a shared account." Saying this at minute 15 saves both of you from a 30-minute misalignment.

### 4. Probe the CHI Software connection.

"Your background is CHI Software — how does Techbar differentiate from that world?" Shows you did homework and gets her to articulate Techbar's actual identity. Also clarifies whether this is a CHI spinoff, an alumni venture, or a fully independent entity — which affects how you assess their stability and footprint.

### 5. If fit exists, get it concrete.

If the referral or co-sell angle lands, push toward specificity: "Is there a client or an opportunity you have in mind, or are we building a relationship we'd activate later?" A warm lead in the room changes the urgency of everything else.